Questions to ask your doctor

FIRST SIGNS | CRANIOSYNOSTOSIS APPOINTMENT CHECKLIST

Take this list to your appointment. Tick what you ask; note the answers.

About the diagnosis

- [ ] What do you think is causing the head shape?
- [ ] Which suture is involved, if any?
- [ ] Is this confirmed or still being investigated?
- [ ] Are there other possible explanations?

About tests

- [ ] What test is being recommended?
- [ ] What question will the test answer?
- [ ] Who will interpret the result?
- [ ] Should another specialist review it?

About the team

- [ ] Which specialists should see my child?
- [ ] Who coordinates the care?
- [ ] Who should we contact with a question between appointments?

About treatment

- [ ] Is treatment necessary?
- [ ] Why is it recommended at this age?
- [ ] What options are appropriate?
- [ ] What are the risks, benefits and limitations?
- [ ] What will recovery involve?
- [ ] What follow-up will be needed?

About costs (India)

- [ ] What will treatment cost, in a written estimate?
- [ ] Which scheme or insurance routes does this hospital accept, and who helps us file?
- [ ] What costs continue after discharge?

About the future

- [ ] How will we monitor development?
- [ ] Are other assessments needed?
- [ ] What should we watch for as our child grows?

And one final question is always reasonable: "Can you please explain that again in simpler language?"

Notes

First Signs provides general educational information. It does not diagnose or treat, and it does not replace a consultation with a qualified medical professional. Draft document, pending medical review.